

HOUSE No. 5188

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Hadley Luddy and Joshua Tarsky

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act establishing a special commission to study access to unemployment insurance in the Commonwealth.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Hadley Luddy</i>	<i>4th Barnstable</i>	<i>1/20/2026</i>
<i>Lisa Field</i>	<i>3rd Bristol</i>	<i>4/15/2026</i>
<i>Michelle L. Badger</i>	<i>1st Plymouth</i>	<i>4/24/2026</i>
<i>Mark D. Sylvia</i>	<i>10th Bristol</i>	<i>4/29/2026</i>

HOUSE No. 5188

By Representatives Luddy of Orleans and Tarsky of Needham, a petition (subject to Joint Rule 12) of Hadley Luddy for an investigation by a special commission (including members of the General Court) to study access to unemployment insurance. Labor and Workforce Development.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act establishing a special commission to study access to unemployment insurance in the Commonwealth.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. (a) There shall be a special commission to study access to unemployment
2 insurance in the commonwealth. The commission shall study and make recommendations for
3 remedying timeliness and equity issues in the processing of claims for unemployment insurance.
4 The commission shall evaluate the structure and operations of the department of unemployment
5 assistance, including the current number of employees and the departmental budget, and make
6 recommendations to improve the department's effectiveness in fulfilling its legislative mandate.

7 (b) The commission shall consist of 9 members: the secretary of labor and workforce
8 development, or a designee; the director of the department of unemployment assistance, or a
9 designee; the chairs of the joint committee on labor and workforce development, or designees;
10 and 5 members to be appointed by the governor, 3 of whom shall have expertise in the
11 administration of unemployment insurance or other social services and 2 of whom shall have
12 experience in pursuing a claim for unemployment insurance in the commonwealth.

13 SECTION 2. Not later than October 1, 2026, the commission shall file a report of its
14 findings, including any legislative, regulatory or budgetary recommendations, with the clerks of
15 the house of representatives and the senate, the house and senate committees on ways and means
16 and the joint committee on labor and workforce development.